11. Mars Colony

Eclipse Cup · upgrade blueprint · src/kart/tracks/mars.ts

Where it is now

3.2 km low gravity: crater in and out or rim road, rift leap, mesa glide or lava tube, big dome. Lap 2 storm and dunes; last lap rocket launch.

What is wrong

Low gravity helps, but otherwise it is roads and jumps.

Core mechanic

Sand and bowls. Loose sand where drifting is everything, and low-gravity crater bowls where you choose a height to ride round the wall and can cut across through the air.

Signature moments

- A crater bowl: ride the wall high or low, or launch across it.
- A rover track with ruts that steer you.
- The rocket launch blast pushes cars on the last lap.

Layout changes

- Rebuild the crater as a drivable bowl, not two jumps.
- More loose sand off the main line.
- Keep the mesa glide and lava tube.

Lap changes

- Lap 2: dunes move across the road.
- Last lap: the storm hides the course; beacons guide you; the rocket blast pushes you.

Engine work needed

- Driving on curved walls (bowl).
- Sand surface and ruts.
- Blast force zone.

Rivals

- Rivals pick a wall height in the bowl.

Done when

- Laps of 50-60 s for a good driver; all 3-lap test races finish with no errors.
- Rivals use every route and the core mechanic, with no more than 2 rival falls per race.
- The core mechanic is in play for at least half the lap, not just one set piece.
- A blind test: a screenshot or a 10-second clip of this track could not be mistaken for any other track.
- Item rows are never on the start line; nothing solid blocks a road by accident.